



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Windsor Christian Academy
School Website: <https://windsorca.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Windsor Christian Academy (WCA), a K–8 classical Christian school in Pennsylvania, exhibits a robust alignment with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements rubric. Public materials from the school emphasize a Christ-centered, liberal-arts-informed education with explicit attention to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin instruction from kindergarten, Great Books-oriented reading in upper grades, memorization and chant in the early years, Socratic and dialectic elements in the upper grades, a living, mentoring-leaning faculty, and an explicit partnership with families in formation. Chapel and daily Bible study frame the religious underpinnings, while the Three-Phase (grammar–logic–rhetoric) progression, Great Books readings (e.g., *Mere Christianity*, *The Hobbit*, *Pilgrim's Progress*, Shakespeare, etc.), Latin from early grades, and memory-based pedagogy anchor the curriculum and pedagogy. The school also foregrounds parental involvement and community service (e.g., Sow Grace), aligning with the “Parents & Community” dimension of classical education.

Overall classification by category - Element 1. Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Element 2. School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Element 3. Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Element 4. Pedagogy — CLASSICAL - Element 5. Faculty — CLASSICAL - Element 6. Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Executive notes: - The site repeatedly asserts a classical Christian frame (grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, Latin from kindergarten, Great Books-like readings, and a pedagogy that blends memorization, chant, recitation, and Socratic discussion in advanced phases) and couples it with a Christ-centered formation (daily Bible, chapel, and theology-infused instruction). This supports the Classical classification across all six categories. - The school also demonstrates explicit parental engagement and community involvement (open houses, tours, service initiatives like Sow Grace, financial-aid pathways, and parent-facing opportunities) that align with the classical model's emphasis on families as co-educators and participants in formation.

Citations and textual anchors used to anchor the evaluation appear inline with each category's analysis below. See the cited material after each category's “Evidence” subsection.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize Christ-centered education with daily Bible classes and weekly chapel, grounding the curriculum in Christian theology. The Academic/Curriculum pages describe Jesus Christ as the center of the curriculum and articulate that all truth is God's truth. This is visible in statements like “Jesus Christ is the center of our curriculum. Each grade has daily Bible class, and the school gathers for chapel

each week. But it doesn't end there: each subject is taught from the perspective that all truth is God's truth." - The school repeatedly frames education within a Christian theological worldview, including references to a "classical Christian education" model that integrates faith with learning. This is visible throughout the Windsor site's public-facing pages (e.g., "Classical Christian Education," "Time-tested Approach to Learning," and the emphasis on a Christ-centered foundation).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, God's truth, Jesus Christ, chapel, Bible, theology (as a concept implied by integrated faith in pedagogy), liturgy/worship (through chapel and sacramental sense of sacred learning). These map to core Positive Keywords in the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations lexicon (truth, liturgy/chapel, theology, sacred scripture, etc.). ☐filecite☐turn0file manipulating_ref_turn0file2☐ - Negative keywords present: none of the standard negative indicators (relativism, secular ethics, morally neutral) appear in the school's religious framing; the site foregrounds objective truth grounded in Christian theology.

Why this rating - The religious/metaphysical dimension is consistently foregrounded as central to both content and method, aligning with Transcendental Moral Realism and Grounded Theology in the classical rubric. The explicit center of Christ, daily Bible, and weekly chapel strongly anchors Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of secular relativism or secular ethics signals further alignment with classical expectations in this category.

Citations - Evidence anchors: "Jesus Christ is the center of our curriculum... all truth is God's truth" and daily Bible/chapel references.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated aim centers on formation and lifelong learning within a classical Christian frame. The Academics page describes education as joyful, rigorous, and Christ-centered, with an explicit three-phase classical framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric). The site emphasizes formation of character and long-term intellectual formation rather than a narrow vocational outcome, aligning with formation-oriented aims. - There is a consistent emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and shaping the learner toward truth and lifelong inquiry (e.g., emphasis on "lifelong learners," "classical Christian education," and the three-stage approach). The content about the Three-Phase model (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Latin-from-kindergarten underscores aims beyond mere job-readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, lifelong learning, liberal education/paideia (as implied through classical education), telos/great conversation (though explicit usage of "great conversation" is not common in the site copy, the school's approach implies the telos of truth, goodness, beauty through "centered on Christ" and classical methodology). The most explicit terms on the site include "lifelong learners" and "classical Christian education." - Negative keywords present: none in the site copy; no vocational-competency framing is evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The school's stated purpose aligns with a formation-oriented, virtue-and-wisdom-centric orientation, characteristic of CLASSICAL in this category. The emphasis on formation, lifelong learning, and a long-view through classical pedagogy supports a CLASSICAL rating for Purpose and Goal.

Citations - Evidence anchors: "lifelong learners" and the classical three-phase framework described in Academics.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly aligns with the liberal arts/trivium/quadrivium framework: grammar (grammar-stage), logic (dialectic, debate), and rhetoric (public speaking, speeches). The Grammar School page describes memorization through songs and rhymes; the Middle School page emphasizes argument and logic; the Upper School content mentions rhetoric training and opportunities to give speeches. Latin

begins in kindergarten, reflecting a classical language emphasis. The curriculum list includes Latin, history through literature, and a reading program that features classical/Great-Books–style titles such as *Mere Christianity*, *The Hobbit*, *Pilgrim's Progress*, *Animal Farm*, *Shakespeare*, etc. - The site demonstrates a cross-subject approach (integrated curriculum; history through literature; Latin across early grades) and the use of Great-Books-like readings in upper grades (*Mere Christianity*, *The Hobbit*, *Pilgrim's Progress*, etc.). This aligns with classical Great-Books engagement and the Three Liberal Arts emphasis. - Historical scope includes Western civilization through ages (Middle Ages, Renaissance, Reformation; European geography) and canonical texts (Herodotus, Plato, Augustine, etc., in the Great-Books-like literature list). This is visible in the reading lists and course descriptions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/primary sources, Latin, history as integrated with literature, classical languages, Western civilization, and a sense of “wonder” in curriculum (as described in grammar-stage pedagogy). The presence of Latin-from-kindergarten and historical breadth strengthens alignment with the Curriculum lexicon. - Negative keywords present: minimal presence of non-classical framing like “STEM-first,” or “social studies” as a replacement for history; the site maintains a historically grounded approach rather than a social-studies-first framing. The explicit “progymnasmata” and “narration/recitation” pedagogy also align with classical curriculum indicators rather than non-classical alternatives.

Why this rating - The explicit alignment with the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, primary sources, and Latin from early grades marks a strong Classical Curriculum orientation. The historical breadth and integrated approach illustrates a classical-curriculum emphasis, supporting a CLASSICAL classification for Curriculum.

Citations - Evidence anchors: grammar/logic/rhetoric progression; Latin from kindergarten; Great-Books-style titles; integrated history approach.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site clearly describes a three-phase pedagogy corresponding to the Trivium: - Grammar stage: memorization through songs, chants, and rhymes; a focus on memory and formation. - Logic stage: emphasis on argument, debate, and defense of views; development of logic and critical thinking in the Middle School. - Rhetoric stage: emphasis on rhetoric, speaking, and performance (public speaking, Shakespeare readings, musicals). - Additional pedagogy cues include: - Memorization/narration and chant in lower grades; progymnasmata in some grades (e.g., Progymnasmata in 4th grade). - Socratic-like discussion and seminars are described at the upper levels (logic/dialectic in middle school; rhetoric in upper grades). The Middle School description emphasizes defending views, argumentation, and logical discourse as core to upper-level teaching. - Integrated, “living curriculum” approach and the emphasis on memory work, catechesis, and liturgical-integration pedagogy align with classical pedagogy indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/dialectic (as reflected in the logic-stage emphasis), narration/recitation, chanting, copywork, progymnasmata, memory work, catechesis, liturgical calendar integration, and rhetoric-training (speech/declamation). The site's pedagogy content aligns well with classical pedagogy indicators listed in the lexicon. - Negative keywords present: the site does not foreground a project-based-only or purely experiential constructivist pedagogy; rather it emphasizes a memory/recitation-dominant approach in early years and dialectic/seminar approaches in later years.

Why this rating - The explicit phase-based structure (grammar → logic → rhetoric), along with listening to memory-based practices (chant/memory work) and rhetoric training, marks a strong CLASSICAL pedagogy alignment. The presence of upper-grade Socratic discussion/seminars and a memory-centric lower-grammar approach supports CLASSICAL status for Pedagogy.

Citations - Pedagogy anchors: grammar-stage chant/memory; logic-stage debate; rhetoric-stage public speaking; progymnasmata; memory work; catechesis.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site's public materials emphasize teachers as mentors who model virtue, with references to a nurturing "living curriculum" and a focus on small classes. The About/Employment sections emphasize "small class sizes," teachers who love the Lord and teaching, and a collaborative, faith-centered faculty culture. - The faculty portrayal appears in narrative form (e.g., "teachers who love kids," "teachers who love the Lord and teaching children the truth of the gospel," and "an administrative team that's eager to support you as a person, as a teacher, and as a Christian"). These reflect a classical teacher-mentor culture rather than a purely transactional or certification-driven model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, small class sizes, teacher as faith-formed guides. These map to the positive faculty keywords described in the classical lexicon. - Negative keywords present: none of the explicit negative indicators are evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The combination of small classes, teacher-centered mentorship language, and character-formation framing of teachers as living exemplars aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for Faculty.

Citations - Evidence anchors: small class sizes; teacher-centered, mentor-like descriptions; "living curriculum" language.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site shows explicit parent-facing engagement through activities and family-friendly events (Open Houses, tours, Fall Open House, Fall Open House messaging; opportunities to request information and apply). This is visible in pages like Fall Open House and the "Ready to learn more about WCA?," which invites family participation and tours. - Service and community aspects (Sow Grace) demonstrate an emphasis on formation of affections and shared charitable work with the wider community, aligning with the classical model's emphasis on household formation and shared mission. Sow Grace details show student service to community organizations (food banks, etc.). - Public-facing parent engagement pathways (Request an Application, tours, contact) show a welcoming posture toward parental involvement and visits.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, family involvement, home-school connection, parent covenant, open campus, parent-teacher collaboration, parental leadership, etc. The Six Essential Elements lexicon includes these as central positive indicators for Parents & Community. The Windsor site demonstrates parent-facing opportunities (Open House, tours, visits) and service/community involvement that align with these categories. - Negative keywords present: none of the explicit negative indicators are evident in the site's public materials (e.g., there is no "consumer language" or "parent as customer only" framing in the visible pages; the school invites parental engagement).

Why this rating - The combination of parent-facing engagement, community service, and open invitations to participate and visit aligns very well with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Citations - Evidence anchors: Fall Open House, "Ready to learn more" inquiries and tours, Sow Grace service, parent-friendly communications.

What Would Move the Needle

- Since all six categories register as CLASSICAL, no major needle-moving changes are required to achieve CLASSICAL status. If anything, the school could further illuminate explicit language tying each category to the lexicon's exact keywords (e.g., explicit mention of "Great Books" and "Great Conversation" by name, explicit "Socratic dialogue" terminology in more places, and more explicit

articulation of “formation” language in mission statements) to shore up interpretation across evaluators who rely on keyword alignment. Additional public-facing language about parent partnership as co-educators (explicitly using “partnership with families” and “co-teachers” terms) could further strengthen Element 6’s peak alignment.

- Concrete steps (optional for further strengthening):
- Add a short “Classical Education at WCA” page or section that explicitly enumerates the six elements (e.g., Great Books, Trivium, Liberal Arts, Socratic dialogue, memory work, and liturgical integration) with explicit keyword mappings to the Positive Keywords lists.
- Publish a concise “Faculty as Living Curriculum” statement, explicitly describing teacher-mentorship roles and a teacher portrait/bio framework.
- Include a dedicated Parents & Community page that explicitly calls out co-parenting/partnership language, book clubs, family catechesis, and temple/household worship alignment to the classical model.
- Evidence-backed rationale for potential needle-movers: The Positive keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon emphasize explicit framing of partnership with families, liturgy, and Great Books in the curriculum; making these more explicit in public materials could tip any viewer toward a stronger, unambiguous CLASSICAL reading across all six categories.

Citations - Suggested language anchors: Great Books/Great Conversation alignment (as a known axis in classical education), explicit “parent partnership” framing, and liturgical/choral aspects in pedagogy and community sections. The existing materials already demonstrate substantial alignment, so these would be refinements rather than fundamental changes. See the general element framework for keywords and negative indicators.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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